There are several variations on Manhattan clam chowder, using vegetables such as celery and green bell peppers. Its defining feature, however, is its tomato base.

manhattan clam chowder

SERVES 4 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 35 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

36 live clams, freshly bought
1 tbsp oil
3–4 slices thick-cut bacon, diced
1 onion, finely chopped
2 floury potatoes, such as russet, peeled and cut into ½ in (1cm) cubes
2 tbsp flour
2 x 14oz (400g) cans chopped tomatoes with their juice
salt and freshly ground black pepper
fresh thyme, to garnish

1 Discard any clams that are open. Shuck the clams and reserve the juice, adding enough water to make 2½ cups. Chop the clams.

2 Heat the oil in a large, heavy saucepan and cook the bacon over medium heat, stirring frequently, for 5 minutes, or until it is crisp. Remove from the pan with a slotted spoon, drain on paper towels, and set aside.

3 Add the onion and potatoes to the pan and cook for 5 minutes, or until the onion has softened. Add the flour and stir for 2 minutes.

4 Stir in the tomatoes and their juice and season to taste with salt and pepper. Cover the pan, reduce the heat, and let simmer for 20 minutes or until the potatoes are tender. Add the clams and simmer gently, uncovered, for 5 minutes. Serve the chowder hot, sprinkled with bacon and thyme.